

Northstar Service source pack

All Northstar Service names, policies and values are synthetic training material. They are not a claim about a real company or a Microsoft tenant.

Executive context

Northstar Service is a fictional service organisation. Its leadership is considering a 30-seat Microsoft 365 Copilot pilot. No real customer records are included. The CEO requires a decision that names the business outcome, data owner, reviewer, measure and stop condition.

Current policies

- BRD-1: External customer commitments require human approval by the service director.
- BRD-2: A board recommendation must distinguish measured pilot results from assumptions.
- BRD-3: Confidential source files may be used only by approved roles; an unexpected Copilot citation triggers an access review.
- BRD-4: Unresolved high-impact safety failures require a hold decision.

Case facts

NS-41 - Excel value model

- Business input: Synthetic task time and cost worksheet
- Expected decision artifact: Net time-saved table
- Named review gate: Review time is deducted from gross saving
- Challenge to test: Gross saving is sold as net value
- Outcome measure: Net minutes saved per task

NS-42 - Benefit confidence

- Business input: Observed sample and management estimates
- Expected decision artifact: Benefit confidence register
- Named review gate: Assumption is never described as measured
- Challenge to test: Weak sample is extrapolated widely
- Outcome measure: Measured share of claimed value

NS-43 - Cost of ownership

- Business input: Seats, enablement and support costs
- Expected decision artifact: Total-cost table
- Named review gate: Include recurring change and review effort
- Challenge to test: License fee is the only cost
- Outcome measure: Cost per realised outcome

NS-44 - Sensitivity test

- Business input: Low, base and high adoption scenarios
- Expected decision artifact: Sensitivity chart with break-even point
- Named review gate: Decision holds under a credible downside
- Challenge to test: Single optimistic case drives approval
- Outcome measure: Break-even adoption threshold

NS-45 - Investment decision

- Business input: Value model and risk register
- Expected decision artifact: Fund, hold or stop recommendation
- Named review gate: Sponsor signs conditions and budget
- Challenge to test: Recommendation ignores risk-adjusted cost
- Outcome measure: Conditions met before release